Present perfect or past simple: what Murphy does not tell you

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red, Unit 20 (pages 50–51): the choice present perfect or past simple. Do **20.1, 20.2** in class, **20.3, 20.4** at home. Day 3: revise the 3rd forms, Appendix 2.
This file adds five things the book does not explain.

1 · Two lists of time words

Present perfect (the time is not finished or not named): *ever · never · just · already · yet · so far · recently · today · this week · this year*
Past simple (a finished time): *yesterday · last night / week / year · two days ago · in 2019 · on Monday · when I was a child · at six o'clock*

2 · News first, details second

I've lost my key. (news) → *I lost it on the bus.* (details: when and where)
Have you seen the film? → *Yes, I saw it last night. It was great.*
The present perfect opens the topic; the past simple tells the story.

3 · "This morning": the period decides

*I **have seen** him this morning.* = it is still the morning now.
*I **saw** him this morning.* = it is already afternoon or evening.
*Have you eaten **today**?* (the day is not over) *I **ate** a lot **yesterday**.*

4 · Questions: Have you…? → When did you…?

Have you been to Khiva? → Yes, I have. → **When did you go?** → I went last summer.
Never: ✗ When ~~have you been~~ there? → ✓ When **did** you go?

5 · The Russian trap

Russian has one past: «Я потерял ключ». English asks: is it connected to now?
«Я потерял ключ (и не могу войти)» → *I **have lost** my key.* «Я потерял ключ вчера» → *I **lost** my key yesterday.*
✗ I ~~have seen~~ him yesterday. ✗ Did you ~~ever~~ see…? is fine in American English, but the book wants Have you ever seen…?

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 Present perfect or past simple? Choose

1. I (have lost / lost) my phone yesterday.
2. (Have you seen / Did you see) the new film? It is great.
3. She (has lived / lived) in Tashkent since 2015.
4. We (have visited / visited) Samarkand in 2019.
5. My brother (has just left / just left in) the house.
6. When (have you been / did you go) to Khiva?
7. I (haven't seen / didn't see) him this week.
8. They (have never eaten / never ate yesterday) sushi.

2 Sort the time words: PP (present perfect) or PS (past simple)?

yesterday · ever · last year · just · in 2020 · already · two days ago · so far · when I was ten · yet · today · on Monday

Present perfect	Past simple

3 Translate into English

1. Я потерял ключ, и я не могу войти.
2. Я потерял ключ вчера в автобусе.
3. Ты видел этот фильм? — Да, я смотрел его на прошлой неделе.
4. Когда вы были в Хиве?
5. Он живёт здесь с 2015 года.
6. Мы ещё не обедали сегодня.
7. Она никогда не видела павлина.

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Alone, then read your sentences aloud.

4 Write news + details: 5 pairs

First a sentence with the present perfect (news), then a sentence in the past simple (details). Example: *I have cut my finger. I cut it when I was making dinner.*

5 Complete the dialogue: present perfect or past simple

A: (1 you / ever / see) _____ a real peacock?

B: Yes, I (2 have) _____. I (3 see) _____ one in a zoo last year.

A: (4 you / like) _____ it?

B: Very much. It (5 open) _____ its tail and everybody (6 take) _____ photos.

A: (7 you / put) _____ the photos online yet?

B: No, I (8 not / do) _____ it yet. I (9 lose) _____ my phone yesterday, and I (10 not / find) _____ it so far.

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 lost · Have you seen · has lived · visited · has just left · did you go · haven’t seen · have never eaten

2 PP: ever · just · already · so far · yet · today PS: yesterday · last year · in 2020 · two days ago · when I was ten · on Monday

3 I have lost my key, and I cannot get in. · I lost my key yesterday on the bus. · Have you seen this film? — Yes, I saw it last week. · When were you in Khiva? · He has lived here since 2015. · We haven’t had lunch yet today. · She has never seen a peacock.

4 Own answers.

5 Have you ever seen · have · saw · Did you like · opened · took · Have you put · haven’t done · lost · haven’t found